



MINISTRY OF EDUCATION

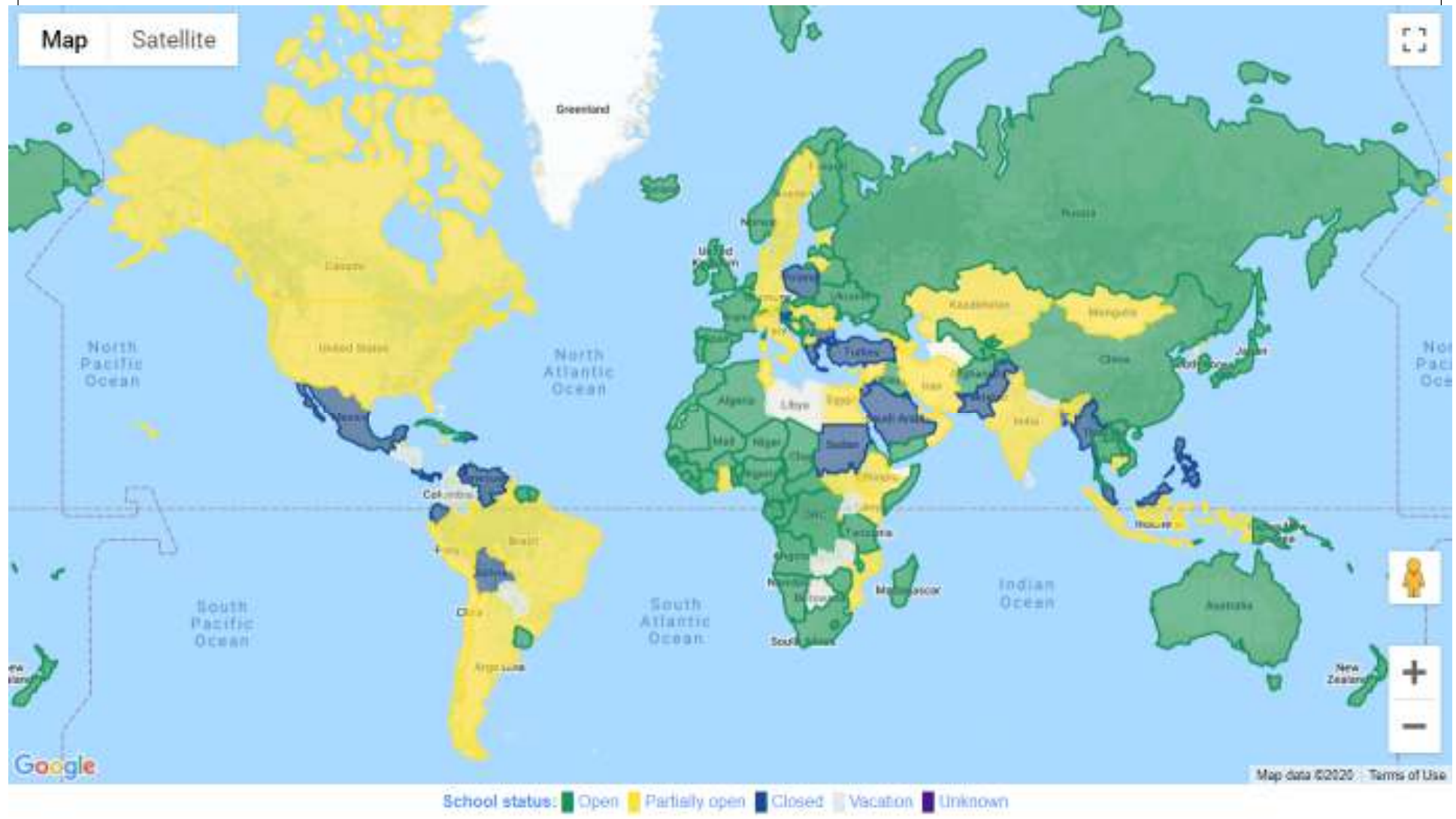
SCHOOL REOPENING IN KENYA AMID COVID-19 PANDEMIC

DECEMBER, 2020



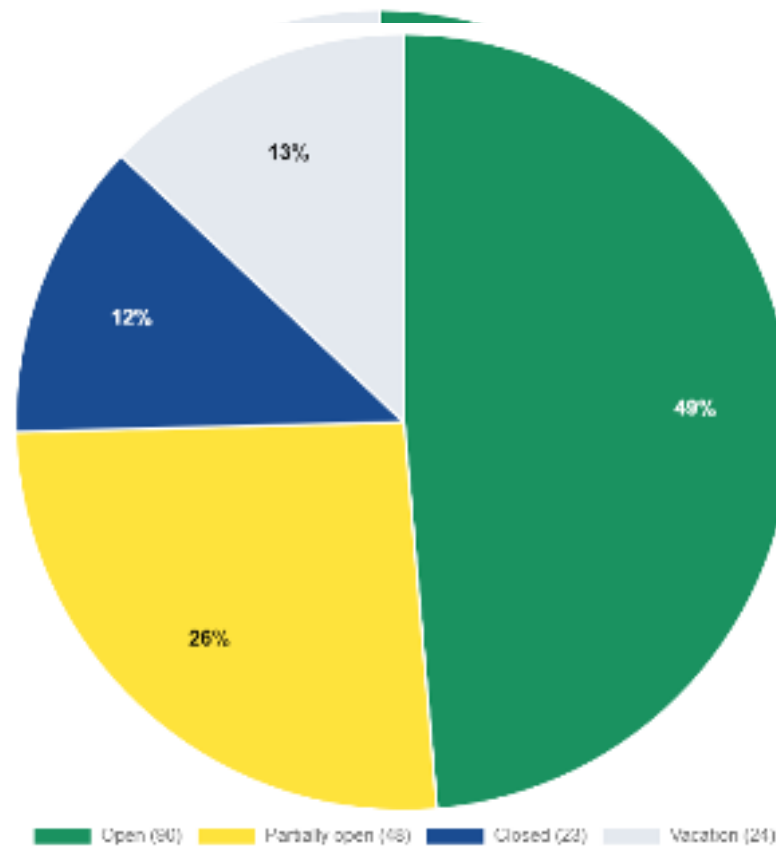
Outline

- Global perspective - school reopening
- Overview of COVID-19
- Kenya COVID-19 Status
- MOE Response to COVID -19
- Schools Response
- Conclusion



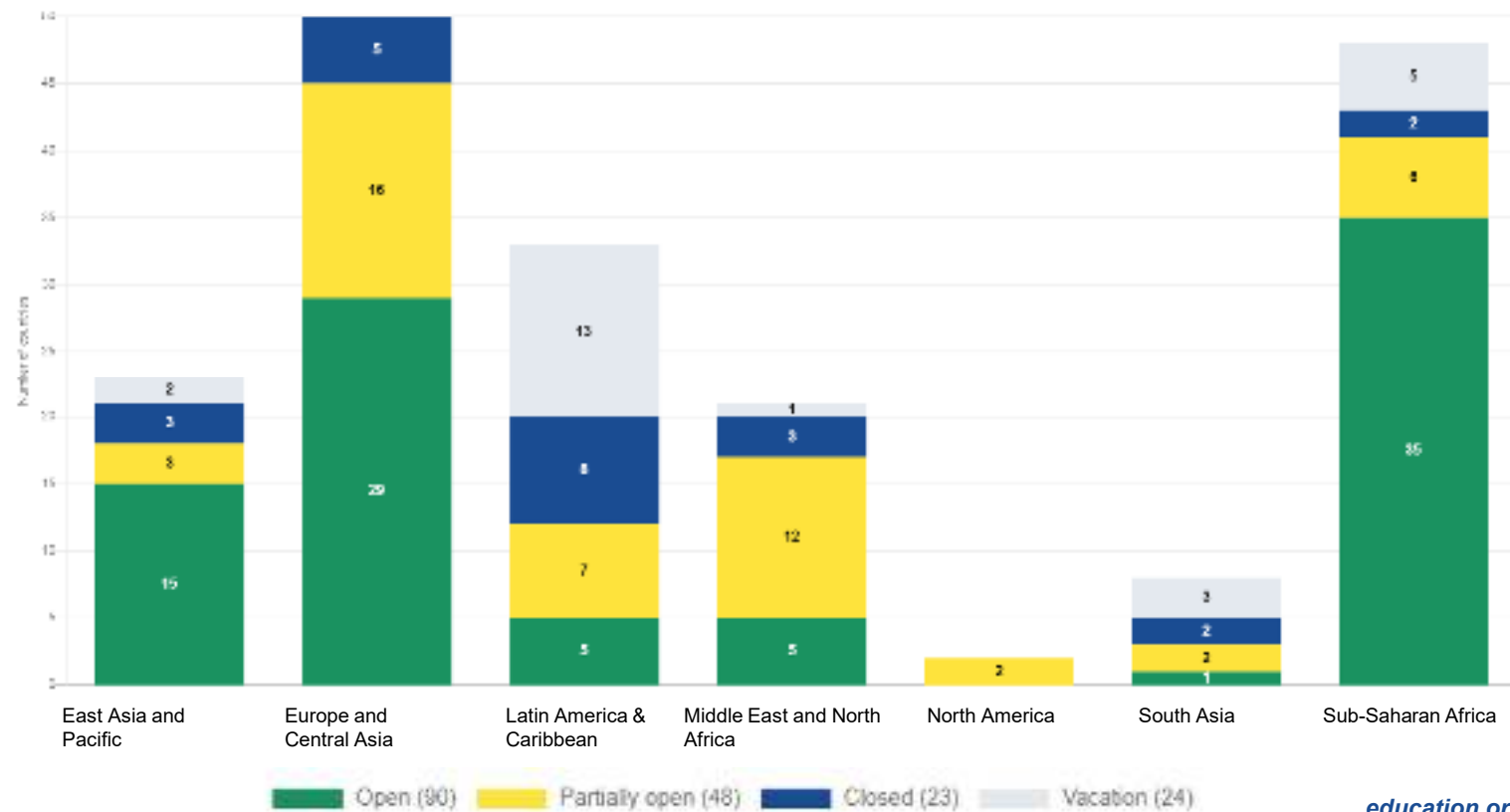
SCHOOLS ARE OPEN IN 75% OF COUNTRIES AS OF DEC 11, 2020

299 days after the first closure, 138 (74%) out of the 185 countries analysed have fully reopened or are partially open.





MOST OPEN SCHOOLS ARE IN AFRICA AND EUROPE REGIONAL STATUS AS OF DEC 11, 2020



NOTABLE FEATURES OF REOPENING IN AFRICA AS OF DEC 11, 2020



Sub-Saharan Africa:

- Among the first to close (lowest cases per 100,000) and earliest to reopen
- More than on any other continent, opened schools before their first peak in cases, with nearly no additional closures
- How did they open safely and stay open?
 - Opening levels gradually
 - d hygiene
 - Engaging teachers and communities
 - Staying transparent and flexible during reopening (new cases)



MEASURES THAT COUNTRIES ARE TAKING TO REMAIN OPEN



CLOSURE POLICIES

If children and staff are found to be infected, closure policies tend to vary in severity and scope, ranging from a case-by-case basis (Italy) to defined thresholds (France).

In terms of limiting the disruption of school infection cases, within some well-resourced countries, the trend is to close, rapidly test all of those with direct contacts – and allow for the school to reopen in 1-3 days.



TESTING

There are strong signs that countries are increasingly seeing an opportunity in fast tracking or rapidly mobilising testing for schools with positive cases, in order to reduce the number of days schools are closed (e.g. Japan, Germany, Luxembourg, some US school districts, Sierra Leone for exam students, Liberia, Lithuania).



PPE AND DISTANCING

Most countries require teachers to wear masks. In most cases, students in upper primary and secondary are also required to wear masks.

Variation is noted – with some countries only requiring them in corridors or high transit areas, and others requiring them in the classroom.

In most countries rigorous and transparent procedures have been established for when students or staff become unwell during the school day.

In parallel, as masks grow in use, classroom distancing and use of shifts and rotations decreases, particularly in Europe.

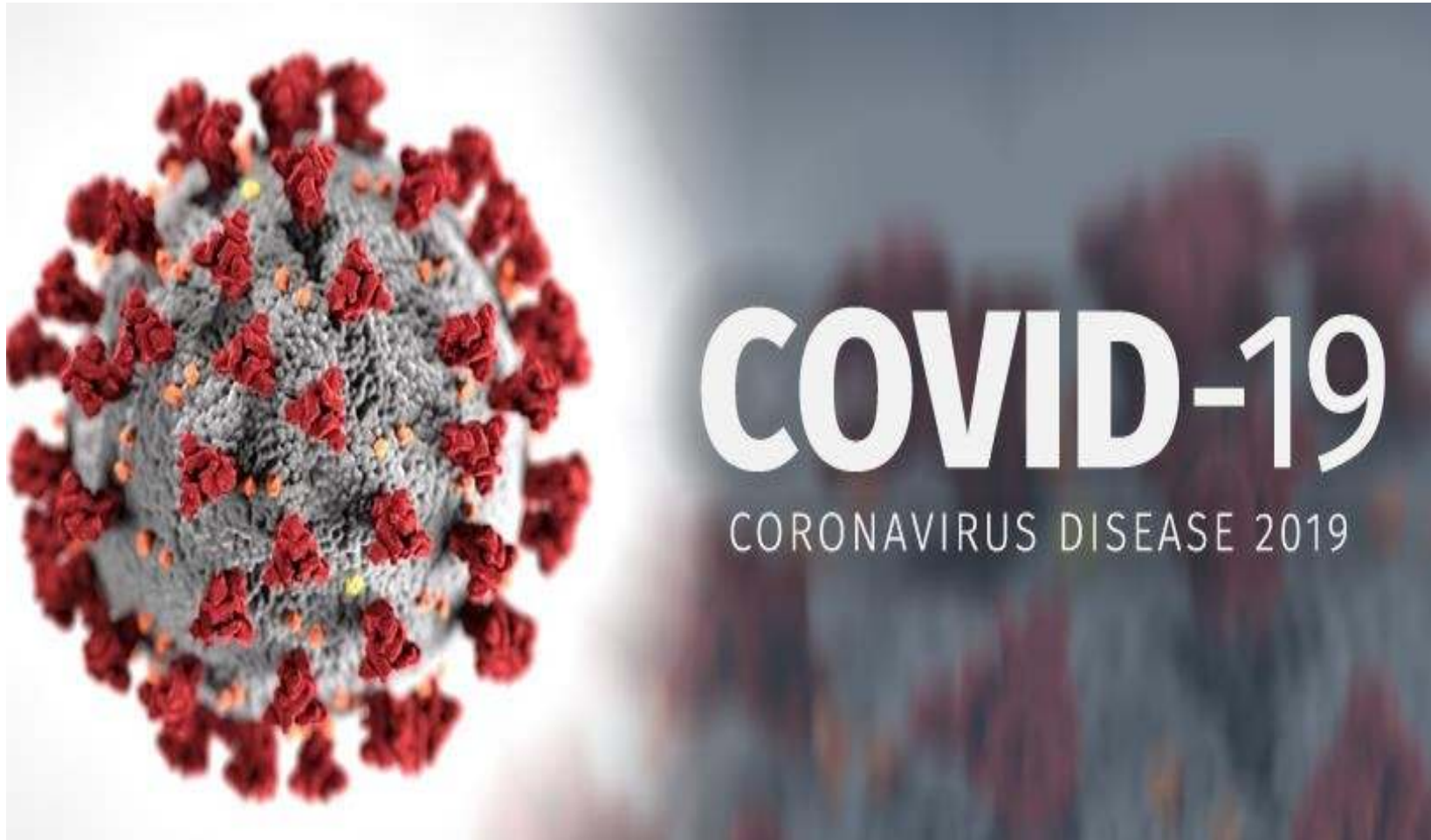


TRANSPARENCY

Establishing trust among the educator and learner/parent community and providing co-developed guidelines, particularly in the case of an increase in local cases, emerges as fundamental to the successful reopening of schools.

In some countries, voiced concerns from the community (UK, South Africa) or relatively short reopening preparation time (Israel) have hindered effective reopening.

COVID-19





What is coronavirus?

- Coronaviruses are a large family of viruses that are known to cause illness ranging from the common cold to more severe diseases such as Middle East Respiratory Syndrome (MERS) and Severe Acute Respiratory Syndrome (SARS)
- Common among animals- zoonotic, animal to human transmission
- Is a respiratory disease caused by SARS-COV -2 Virus



COVID-19

- First reported in Wuhan city, Hubei Province, China in December, 2019
- Started from local seafood market, known to sell live and freshly slaughtered hunted animals
- BAT
- SNAKES, PANGOLINS(an ant-eater)



Global status as at **13 December 2020**

The coronavirus COVID-19 is affecting 218 countries and territories around the world and 2 international conveyances

- Confirmed Cases- **72,126,781**
- Deaths- **1,611,959**
- **Recovered-** **50,506,734**



Kenya Status-13th December , 2020

- COVID-19 has reached the level of world wide pandemic
- Confirmed Cases- 91,526
- Deaths- 1,586
- Recovered - 72,596
- High risk counties
- Social assessment for vulnerable and marginalized groups



How COVID-19 Spreads

- The virus is thought to spread mainly from person-to-person.
 - Between people who are in close contact with one another (within about 6 feet) for 15 minutes or more
 - Through respiratory droplets produced when an infected person coughs, sneezes or talks.
 - These droplets can land in the mouths or noses of people who are nearby or possibly be inhaled into the lungs.
 - Some recent studies have suggested that COVID-19 may be spread by people who are not showing symptoms.

(The best way to prevent illness is to avoid being exposed to this virus.)



COVID-19 (coronavirus) in children

- Children of all ages can become ill with coronavirus disease 2019 (COVID-19) and can transmit it to others.
- Children don't become sick as often as adults.
- Most children have mild symptoms or no symptoms.
- Most children recover within one to two weeks, **adults 2-6 weeks**
- In the US, hospitalization rates for children are also much lower than for adults-10% of all COVID-19 cases.
- .



COVID-19 (coronavirus) in children

- Children with underlying conditions, such as obesity, diabetes and asthma, congenital heart disease, genetic conditions like sickle cell disease or conditions affecting the nervous system or metabolism are also at higher risk of serious illness with COVID-19



Symptoms of COVID-19

- Fever or chills
- Cough
- Shortness of breath or difficulty breathing
- Fatigue
- Muscle or body aches, Diarrhea, Nausea or vomiting
- Headache
- New loss of taste or smell
- Sore throat
- Congestion or runny nose



COVID 19 Advanced Symptoms

Individuals should seek immediate medical attention if they display the following advanced symptoms:

- Trouble breathing
- Persistent pain or pressure in the chest
- New confusion
- Inability to wake or stay awake
- Bluish lips or face



Prevention of COVID 19

- Regularly and thoroughly clean your hands with soap and running water for at least 20 seconds
- If soap and water are not readily available, use a hand sanitizer 'hand rub' that contains at least 60% alcohol.
- Maintain at least 1 meter physical distance
- Avoid going to crowded places
- Avoid touching your Face (eyes, nose and mouth).
- Practice good respiratory hygiene (covering your mouth and nose with your bent elbow or tissue when you cough or sneeze).
- **Stay home and self-isolate** even with minor symptoms such as cough, headache, mild fever, until you recover.



Prevention of COVID 19

- Avoid close contact with anyone who has cold or flu-like symptoms. *If possible, maintain 6 feet between the person who is sick and other household members.*
- Clean and disinfect regularly touched surfaces frequently. This includes toys, play areas, tables, doorknobs, light switches, countertops, rails, handles, desks, phones, keyboards, toilets, faucets, and sinks.
- Always wear a face mask while in public spaces including schools
- Avoid shaking hands or hugging people.
- Avoid social gatherings eg parties
- If you have a fever, cough and difficulty breathing, seek medical attention early. Inform the health facility staff if you



Prevention of COVID 19

Wearing of Face Masks

Masks help prevent spread of the virus from one person to another.

Types of Masks

- Surgical masks
- N95 masks
- Cloth masks



MOE Response

- Government announced the closure of all schools and learning institutions on March 15, 2020, as part of the measures to control the spread of COVID-19
- Ministry developed Kenya Basic Education COVID-19 Emergency Response Plan , 2020
- Inauguration of Education COVID 19 response committee on 12th May 2020



Which recommended:

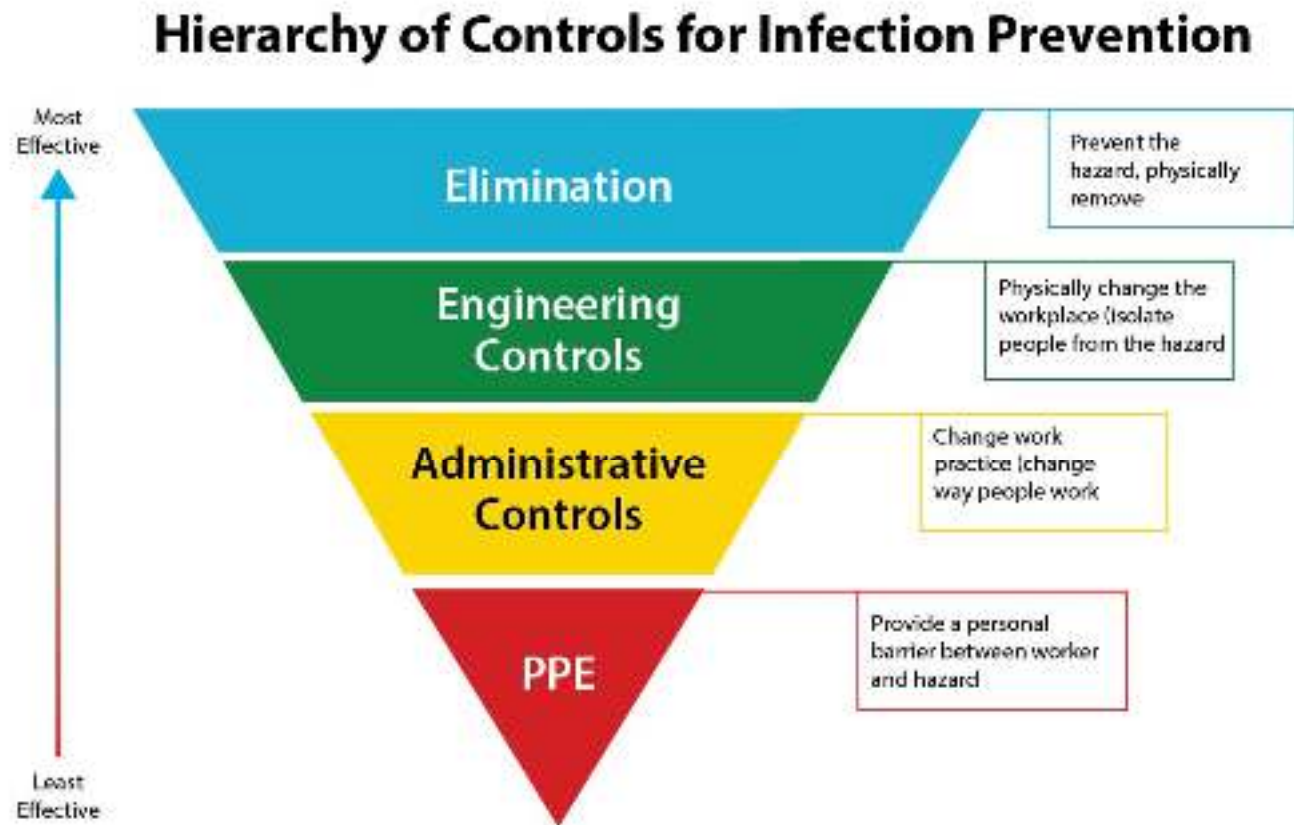
- Gradual safe reopening of learning institutions
- Staggered and in shifts where applicable
- Priority be accorded to finalist and examination classes
- Grade 4, CBC pioneer
- Reopening process(prior to reopening, part of reopening, with schools reopened
- Government implementing phased reopening which commenced from 12th October, 2020



Guidelines on Health & Safety Protocols

- Guidelines provide prevention, early detection, infection control and management measures of COVID-19 in educational institutions.
- To be understood by teachers, non-teaching staff, learners, parents and entire school community
- Enable institution leadership, management and communities to prepare for safe reopening of schools
- Basic infrastructure to be put in place to facilitate the recommended infection control measures and adhere to physical/ social distancing measures.

Reopening Focus





School Response

- School COVID 19 Response team-focal persons
- Temperature screening - entrance to the compound
- Hand washing facilities (soap and running water)- multiple places
- Hand sanitizing facilities- multiple places
- Maintain at least 1 meter physical distance between learners at all times (classes, dining, labs, dormitories etc)
- Wearing of face masks by all learners, teachers and other staff.



School Response

- Cleaning and Disinfection of the classrooms at the end of the day
- Fumigation
- Avoid going to crowded places
- Avoid touching your Face (eyes, nose and mouth).
- EIC materials displayed in strategic places
- School transport- social distance, sanitizing, disinfection
- Reduce number of visitors in schools
- Well ventilated
- Pedal-operated waste collection bins with liners at point of use/Dust bin , non-touch



School Response

- Holding room for those who may have fever or any other symptoms suggestive of COVID 19
- Emergence contact
- Linkages to a health facility
- Ambulance services
- PPE for emergency response
- Psychosocial and mental health wellness
- **Stay home and self-isolate** even with minor symptoms such as cough, headache, mild fever, until you recover.

There are certain places where COVID-19 spreads more easily:



Crowded places

with many people nearby



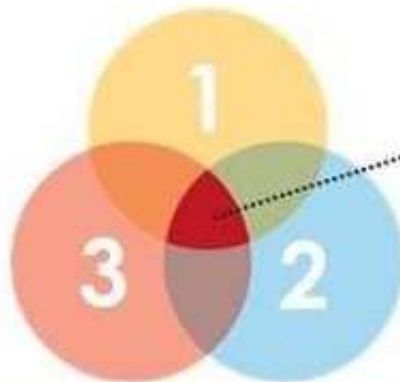
Close-contact settings

Especially where people have close-range conversations



Confined and enclosed spaces

with poor ventilation



The risk is higher in places where these factors overlap.

Even as restrictions are lifted, consider where you are going and #StaySafe by avoiding the Three Cs.

Stay Healthy





Social assessment – Who is at a higher risk?

- Younger children (e.g., preschool)
- Anyone who has trouble breathing
- Anyone who is unconscious, incapacitated
- People who are deaf or hard of hearing- not read lips
- People with intellectual and developmental disabilities, mental health conditions or other sensory sensitivities
- Vulnerable and marginalized groups
- Persons / learners with underlying conditions, such as obesity, diabetes and asthma, congenital heart disease, genetic conditions like sickle cell disease or conditions affecting the nervous system or metabolism



Thank You